BELIEF COUNSELING FOR COUNSELORS

# The Process

Three steps: Identify, Challenge, and Replace. The result: the truth sets you free.

## The flow of Belief Counseling

Every client moves through the same path. Belief Mining uncovers the beliefs; the three steps change them.

**Presenting Problem**
Why the client came: the distress, the symptoms, the story

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**Belief Mining**
Dig through six levels to find what the client believes

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**1 Identify**
Name the false belief in the client's own words

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**2 Challenge**
Question it, refute it, and test it

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**3 Replace**
Put biblical truth in its place and practice it

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**The Truth Sets You Free**
The result of the three steps (John 8:32)

↻ When another false belief comes to light, return to Belief Mining and Step 1, and work through the steps again.

## Each part of the flow

## Belief Mining

Start with the presenting problem, then gather the whole story and look for the beliefs beneath it at six levels:

- Biological
- Psychological/Cognitive
- Interpersonal
- Socioeconomic
- Sociocultural
- Spiritual/Religious

*Why: You cannot find the right belief until you know the person.*

## 1. Identify False Beliefs

- Put the specific false belief into words, in the client's own language.
- Check it against the 22 Core False Beliefs and the Spiritual/Religious False Beliefs.
- Choose the belief that, if changed, would bring the greatest relief.

*Why: You cannot challenge a belief you haven't named.*

## 2. Challenge False Beliefs

- **Questioning:** ask general and Christian questions that let the client examine the belief for themselves.
- **Refuting:** weigh the belief against evidence, Scripture, logic, and the client's own experience.
- **Behavioral experiments:** do something differently and see what actually happens.

*Why: A belief held for years needs more than a gentle doubt.*

### 3. Replace False Beliefs

- Replace the lie with biblical truth, such as “I am imperfect, but deeply loved by God.”
- Use the Scriptural Truths for the belief, and Pearls Scripture Search for more.
- Practice the truth with homework: Scripture memory, reminder cards, songs, listening, and journaling.
- Review progress, belief strength, and remaining triggers.

*Why: Removing a lie leaves a gap; truth must take its place, and beliefs change through repetition.*

### The Truth Sets You Free

Freedom is not a fourth step. It is what happens when a lie is identified, challenged, and replaced with God’s truth.

## Key Scriptures

> *“Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God.”* **Romans 12:2**

> *“We tear down arguments and every presumption set up against the knowledge of God; and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ.”* **2 Corinthians 10:5**

> *“Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.”* **John 8:32**

> *“I have hidden Your word in my heart that I might not sin against You.”* **Psalm 119:11**

> *“All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for instruction, for conviction, for correction, and for training in righteousness.”* **2 Timothy 3:16**